THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 9 ENGLISH — READING SKILL PAPER SET 05

Reading Comprehension | RBSE Board Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 45 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 20**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Section A has one passage with 12 questions (1 mark each).
3. Section B has one case-based passage with 8 questions (1 mark each).
4. Questions include MCQs and short answers of 30–40 words.
5. Write the question number before each answer.
6. Answers must be written in the answer book in the order of the questions.

SECTION — A (Reading Comprehension: Factual / Discursive Passage, 400–450 words) 12 Marks

Read the passage and answer the questions.

1. *Read the passage carefully and answer the questions that follow.* 12

The humble bicycle is making a quiet comeback. In many cities, people who once travelled by car have begun to ride to work, to the market and to school. The reasons are simple. A bicycle needs no fuel, takes little space and produces no smoke. It also keeps the rider fit, which no car can promise.

City planners are noticing the trend. Some have marked special lanes where cycles can move safely, away from fast traffic. Others have set up stands where a person can hire a cycle for an hour and leave it at another stand. Such schemes have already cut the number of short car trips in a few cities.

The bicycle is also among the kindest machines for the environment. It needs no petrol, makes no smoke and takes only a fraction of the road space that a car occupies. Ten bicycles can be parked in the place where one car stands. A city that encourages cycling therefore breathes cleaner air, hears less noise and spends less on widening its roads.

Several towns have already shown the way. They have painted separate lanes for cyclists, built secure stands near bus stops and metro stations, and allowed riders to borrow a bicycle for a small fee and leave it at another stand. Where such lanes exist, children cycle to school without fear and older people take to the pedals for exercise. A bicycle, it seems, is not a machine of the past but a vehicle waiting for the right roads.

Cycling is good for the rider as well. Thirty minutes a day strengthens the heart, tones the legs and clears the mind, and unlike a gym it costs nothing after the first purchase. The rider also learns to notice his surroundings, such as the smell of rain on the road or the shape of a neighbourhood he only used to glimpse through a window. Perhaps that is why those who give up their cars for a few months often say that the city seemed to grow smaller, friendlier and far more interesting.

Yet cycling is not free of troubles. In crowded roads without lanes, riders fear accidents. Rain and heat make long rides tiring, and thieves target unlocked cycles. If cycling is to grow, authorities must make roads safer and citizens must show consideration to riders. A cycle may be small, but the change it promises is large.

(i) The writer's main point is that: 1

(a) cycling is returning and needs support **(b)** cars are cheaper

(c) cycles are old-fashioned **(d)** cities are shrinking

(ii) A bicycle is better than a car because it: 1

(a) goes faster **(b)** is more costly

(c) needs no fuel and causes no smoke **(d)** carries more people

(iii) City planners have: 1

(a) marked cycle lanes and hire stands **(b)** raised taxes
(c) closed roads **(d)** banned cars

(iv) Which problem of cyclists is NOT mentioned? 1

(a) Lack of air in tyres **(b)** Fear of accidents
(c) Tiring weather **(d)** Theft

(v) 'Quiet comeback' suggests that the change is: 1

(a) violent **(b)** gradual and unnoticed
(c) forced **(d)** loud and sudden

(vi) Give two reasons why people are turning to bicycles. 1

(vii) What do hire stands allow? 1

(viii) What effect have such schemes had? 1

(ix) What must authorities do to promote cycling? 1

(x) Find a word in the passage that means 'plain and ordinary'. 1

(xi) Ten bicycles can be parked in the space needed for: 1

(a) one truck **(b)** one bus **(c)** one car **(d)** two cars

(xii) Name one thing towns have done to encourage cycling. 1

SECTION — B (Reading Comprehension: Case-based Passage, 200–250 words) — 8 Marks

Read the text and answer the questions.

2. *Read the following case and answer the questions that follow.* 8

The table below shows the number of books borrowed from the school library by students of different classes during one month.

Class	Fiction	Science	Biography
VI	120	40	20
VII	110	55	25
VIII	90	70	30
IX	60	85	45

The librarian, Mrs Chauhan, studied the figures and noticed that fiction is the favourite of younger students, while older students prefer science and biographies. She believes that this is natural, because as students move to higher classes they start to look for knowledge that helps them with their studies and with decisions about their future. At the same time she has noticed that the total number of books borrowed in Class IX is lower than that of Class VI, and she would like to change this.

To encourage reading, she plans a 'Book of the Month' display, in which a short review by a student will be pinned next to the chosen book. She will also invite local authors and scientists to talk to students once a term.

Class teachers have also been asked to give students one library period every week, and to inform the librarian about the topics being taught, so that suitable books can be kept ready on the shelves.

(i) Which class borrowed the most fiction books? 1

(a) IX **(b)** VI **(c)** VII **(d)** VIII

(ii) How many science books did Class VIII borrow? 1

(a) 30 **(b)** 85 **(c)** 70 **(d)** 90

(iii) According to Mrs Chauhan, older students prefer: 1

(a) science and biographies **(b)** comics

(c) only fiction **(d)** newspapers

(iv) The 'Book of the Month' display will carry: 1

(a) a short review by a student **(b)** a quiz

(c) the author's photograph **(d)** a price list

(v) What is the total number of books borrowed by Class IX? 1

(vi) Why does the librarian think older students prefer such books? 1

(vii) Which class borrowed the fewest biographies? 1

(viii) Whom will she invite once a term? 1

END OF QUESTION PAPER **Total: 20 Marks**

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